

Linux Torvalds releases Linux 5.3

Linux kernel boss Linus Torvalds has finally announced the release of Linux 5.3, after eight release candidates and a delay of one week.

The update includes a host of fixes for AMD and Intel graphics drivers, including better support for Radeon RX 5700 Navi, Intel Icelake Gen 11 graphics, and early Intel HDR display support.

Torvalds clarified that the delay was because of his travel schedule rather than any pending issues. However, he thinks the extra week was good because it allowed for some 'good fixes' to come in.

"One particularly last-minute revert is the top-most commit (ignoring the version change itself) done just before the release, and while it's very annoying, it's perhaps also instructive," wrote Torvalds.

He explained that the commit he reverted wasn't actually buggy, but it did its job so well that "...much improved IO patterns it caused then ended up revealing a user-visible regression due to a real bug in a completely unrelated area."

He noted that the decision to revert a change is taken based on user-reported behaviour, not based on some "it changes the ABI" or "it caused a bug" concept.

Linux kernel 5.3 also introduces a new `pidfd_open(2)` system call that promises to: help service managers handle PID reuse issues, support the `umwait x86` instructions for more power efficient userspace, support the lightweight and flexible ACRN embedded hypervisor, and support 16 millions new IPv4 addresses in the 0.0.0.0/8 range.

In addition, numerous new and updated drivers are included in the Linux 5.3 kernel series. However, this is currently a 'mainline' kernel, and it is suggested that it not be used in production environments.

Oracle Autonomous Linux launched

Oracle Autonomous Linux, along with the new Oracle OS Management Service, is the first and only-autonomous operating environment that eliminates complexity and human error to deliver unprecedented cost savings, security and



availability for customers, the company claims in a statement.

Keeping systems patched and secure is one of the biggest ongoing challenges faced by IT today. With Oracle Autonomous Linux, the company says that customers can rely on autonomous

capabilities to help ensure their systems are secure and highly available to help prevent cyber attacks.

"Oracle Autonomous Linux builds on Oracle's proven history of delivering Linux with extreme performance, reliability and security to run the most demanding enterprise applications," said Wim Coekaerts, senior vice president of operating systems and virtualisation engineering, Oracle.

"Today we are taking the next step in our autonomous strategy with Oracle Autonomous Linux, providing a rich set of capabilities to help our customers significantly improve reliability and protect their systems from cyber threats," Coekaerts added.

Microsoft and Apple to support Academy Software Foundation's open source projects

The Academy Software Foundation (ASWF), a collaborative effort to advance open source software development in the motion picture and media industries, has recently added Microsoft and Apple as premier members.

Launched in August 2018 by the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences and the Linux Foundation, the ASWF provides a neutral forum for open source



software developers to share resources and collaborate on technologies for image creation, visual effects, animation and sound.

The addition of Microsoft has helped the organisation grow past US\$ 1 million in annual funding.

"We are pleased to welcome Microsoft to the Academy Software

Foundation. Its membership helps us hit a significant milestone as we surpass US\$ 1 million in annual funding, a solid financial base that we will use to support our open source projects, the software engineers that develop them, and the open source community in general," said David Morin, executive director of the Academy Software Foundation.

As a Foundation member, Microsoft will dedicate engineering resources to support Foundation-hosted projects and will join the group's governing board and its technical advisory council.

"We're excited to become a member of the Academy Software Foundation and work together with the industry's open source community to bring the latest cloud technologies to the Foundation and its projects," said Tad Brockway, corporate vice president, Azure Storage, Media and Edge, Microsoft Corp.



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